



17th & Chew Street
Post Office Box 7017
Allentown, PA 18105-7017

Tel: (610) 402-3950
Fax: (610) 402-3951

FACSIMILE

Date: 4-26

Name: Das

Organization: 312 573 8816

Fax: Steve R.

From:

Subject:

Pages: 3 (Including Cover Sheet)

Comments: Work plan
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Work Plan to Establish the T/MC Evaluation SystemYear 11st Quarter

- 1) 1. Evaluator trains T/MC staff on Documentation System for Community Initiatives (DSCI)
 - A. Training workshop (3 days in Chicago)
 - B. Practice and follow-up (2 weeks by phone and email)
2. Evaluator and T/MC staff develop T/MC-specific DSCI data collection forms and procedures (2 weeks)
- 2) 3. Evaluator and T/MC staff develop T/MC on-line database and data collection system (2 weeks)
4. T/MC staff begin monthly data entry (2 to 6 hours per month)
5. Phone conferences between T/MC staff and evaluator to review progress (2 to 10 hours per month)

2nd Quarter

1. Evaluator trains T/MC staff on synthesis and analysis of data and production of quarterly reports (2 weeks by email and phone)
2. Evaluator and T/MC staff produce 1st report using DSCI data
3. Evaluator and T/MC staff review DSCI system and make improvements for utility and accuracy (in person visit to Chicago)
4. Evaluator and T/MC staff begin project to retrospectively assess T/MC accomplishments with the DSCI; begin search for university and high school interns to assist (in person visit to Chicago)
5. Continue monthly data entry and phone conferences to review progress

3rd Quarter

1. Continue monthly data entry and phone conferences to review progress
2. Prepare 2nd T/MC evaluation report and disseminate to T/MC stakeholders (T/MC staff with evaluator support)
3. Begin retrospective application of DSCI on T/MC work completed between 1996 through 2000 (Evaluator, T/MC staff, interns from local universities and high schools)

4th
Quarter

1. Continue data collection, results synthesis, posting results on the Internet for feedback, and phone conferences to review progress.
2. Prepare 3rd T/MC evaluation report and disseminate results to stakeholders by mail and Internet postings.
3. Continue retrospective evaluation of T/MC work completed between 1994 through 2000.
4. Continue to introduce other support organizations and tutor/mentor groups to the evaluation system through the T/MC newsletter, Internet site, and T/MC leadership conferences.
5. Begin to train participating organizations how to become trainers for evaluation to peers and peer organizations.
6. Introduce evaluation system to tutor/mentor program recipients of Chicago Bar Foundation (CBF) grants during the May 2001 T/MC Leadership Conference and use CBF grant program to leverage adoption of evaluation as a best practice.
7. Conduct the 1st Annual Constituent Survey of Outcomes, through which local, regional and national stakeholders (e.g., experts in the fields of tutoring/mentoring and youth development) judge the value of T/MC outcomes to date.

(Please note that while this evaluation system is designed to encourage sharing and co-learning, no information shared on the Internet will include confidential information of individuals. Access to enter data will be password-protected and allowed only after training.)

Preliminary Plans for the 2nd Year

1. Continue data collection, results synthesis, posting results on the Internet for feedback, and phone conferences to review progress.
2. Prepare 3rd T/MC evaluation report and disseminate results to stakeholders by mail and Internet postings.
3. Continue to introduce other support organizations and tutor/mentor groups to the evaluation system through the T/MC newsletter, Internet site, and T/MC leadership conferences.
4. Summarize and analyze the results from the 1st Annual Constituent Survey of Outcomes and prepare report.
5. Complete retrospective evaluation of T/MC initial six years of work and begin data analyses.
6. Use the lessons learned from the organizations using the Internet evaluation system to leverage funding and support for technology resources and support for those tutor/mentor organizations without such technology and Internet access.
7. Present 1st year's overall results using T/MC's evaluation system at the November 2001 T/MC Leadership Conference.

In an earlier evaluation of T/MC Chapin Hall researchers concluded that:

(a) T/MC was helping hundreds of Chicago tutor/mentor programs to improve and sustain their efforts and

(b) T/MC's unique roles (e.g., helping programs gain money and recruit volunteers, train staff, generate collaboration, and build support networks) were not and could not be filled by other government and non-profit institutions.

Yet, the researchers reported that it was difficult to evaluate and capture the true value of a complex and unique organization like T/MC, and that absent such evaluation it would be difficult for T/MC and other organizations to understand, improve, share, and replicate its efforts. The proposed evaluation system is designed to address these concerns through an ongoing, systematic process incorporated into daily work functions of the T/MC and other organizations that adopt it. Throughout the second year, T/MC staff and the evaluator will work closely to disseminate the initial lessons learned for how to support, expand, and enhance tutor/mentor programs. It is hoped that by the end of the second year a critical mass of organizations will be using the evaluation system and that the system's value will allow for a subscription fee for participating organizations to help offset the costs of expanding and enhancing the evaluation support and resources. This fee would be much smaller than the cost for any one organization to initiate its own evaluation system and support. Foundation and corporate funding will be sought to minimize such costs. From year 3 onwards, the number of organizations and tutor/mentor programs evaluating their efforts may be sufficient enough to begin seeing the aggregate contributions and population-level outcomes of T/MC, other support organizations, and tutor/mentor programs for youth and neighborhoods throughout Chicago.

WORK PLAN TO ESTABLISH THE TUTOR/MENTOR CONNECTION EVALUATION SYSTEM

Lead evaluator: Stergios T. Roussos, M.P.H.

Specific aims of this project:

1. Establish an Internet-based evaluation system that will permit systematic, ongoing assessment of (and feedback for) the Tutor/Mentor Connection (T/MC) process and outcomes in its mission to improve the quantity and quality of tutor/mentor programs in Chicago.
2. Through application of this system in T/MC's Kids Connection program, model how other tutor/mentor programs can evaluate program-specific functions and outcomes.
3. Expand and enhance the capacity of support organizations such as T/MC, and other tutor/mentor programs to evaluate and improve their efforts.

1st Year

1 st Quarter	1. Evaluator and T/MC (Kids Connection) staff adopt and modify tools from the Documentation System for Community Initiatives (DSCI) to design data collection procedures and forms 2. Evaluator and T/MC staff develop Internet data base and data collection system housed on existing T/MC Internet site; all tools and directions are made available on the Internet and can be downloaded to individual computers. 3. Evaluator trains T/MC staff on how to use the new evaluation system. 4. T/MC staff begin to enter data. Staff and evaluator meet by phone (monthly, at minimum) to review progress. 5. Begin using the Jordan-Web T/MC Internet-based Survey (http://jordan-webb.net/tmc) to get feedback from stakeholders regarding the importance and value of the results (includes posting results on T/MC Internet site and partnering Internet sites).
2 nd Quarter	1. Continue data collection, results synthesis, posting results on the Internet for feedback, and phone conferences to review progress 2. Evaluator trains T/MC staff on synthesis and analysis of data and production of quarterly reports 3. Evaluator and T/MC staff produce 1st quarter evaluation report and disseminate results to stakeholders by mail and Internet postings. 4. Evaluator and T/MC staff meet to review evaluation system procedures and products and make any improvements. 5. Begin planning the retrospective evaluation of T/MC accomplishments from its start in 1994 and to 2000 using the DSCI. 6. (Contingent on receipt of funding in Summer 2000) Introduce T/MC evaluation system and its application to other organizations and tutor/mentor programs during the November 2000 T/MC Leadership Conference.
3 rd Quarter	1. Continue data collection, results synthesis, posting results on the Internet for feedback, and phone conferences to review progress. 2. Prepare 2nd T/MC evaluation report and disseminate results by mail and Internet postings. 3. T/MC staff, interns from local universities and high schools, and evaluator begin retrospective evaluation of T/MC (building on the original Chapin Hall evaluation report of T/MC, and other archival data sources) 4. Continue to introduce other support organizations and tutor/mentor programs to the evaluation system through the T/MC newsletter, Internet site, and semi-annual T/MC Leadership Conferences. 5. Begin search for additional funding to expand evaluation support depending on the number of interested organizations. 6. Meet to discuss plans and applications for this evaluation system in Year 2